

🎯 HIRING MANAGER INTERVIEW PREPARATION

Role: Implementation Manager - Just Walk Out (JWO)

Job ID: 10391259

Candidate: Juan Murillo

Interview Phase: Phase 1 - Hiring Manager Round

Date Prepared: May 19, 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY FOR HIRING MANAGER

Your Positioning Statement

“I’m a Technical Program Manager with 8+ years driving customer-facing delivery. I’ve implemented Zendesk across business units, managed payment gateway deployments to commercial customers, led eCommerce platform launches, and coordinated with customers throughout complex technical projects. JWO is fundamentally about implementing a complex technology across retail stores with diverse needs. I excel at managing customer expectations, coordinating technical delivery, and ensuring successful adoption. That’s exactly what JWO needs.”

Why You’re a Fit for JWO

- ✓ **Customer-Facing PM:** Zendesk implementation, eCommerce platform, customer satisfaction focus
- ✓ **Implementation Management:** Multiple successful software implementations
- ✓ **Stakeholder Coordination:** Managed diverse stakeholder needs across business units
- ✓ **Change Management:** Led organizational change (eCommerce, agile transformation)
- ✓ **Cross-Functional Delivery:** Worked with ops, engineering, support, commercial teams
- ✓ **Problem-Solving:** Reduced customer issues 90% (100 → 10 per week), improved response time 50x

Hiring Manager’s Likely Focus

The Hiring Manager will assess: 1. **Can you manage customer-facing implementations?** (Core JWO role) 2. **Can you coordinate across diverse stakeholders?** (Store operators, corporate, tech teams) 3. **Can you drive adoption in the field?** (JWO-specific challenge) 4. **Will you own customer satisfaction?** (JWO measure of success)

CRITICAL GAPS & YOUR RESPONSE STRATEGY

The Gap: Retail Store Operations Experience

JWO role requires understanding retail operations, store environments, retail staff needs. You have limited direct retail experience.

Your Strategy: - **Acknowledge:** “I haven’t worked in retail operations directly, but I’ve implemented software across different business units with different operational needs. I understand how to translate technology to operational context.” - **Leverage:** “At Sakara, I implemented eCommerce platform features to reduce live-site support from 100 to 10 issues per week. That’s the same principle as JWO—understanding operational pain and delivering solutions. I’ve also managed business process optimization (BPM) across operations teams.” - **Commitment:** “Retail operations are learnable. I’ll partner with your store operators to understand their workflows, constraints, and success metrics. In 3-4 weeks, I’ll have working knowledge of store operations. In 8-12 weeks, I’ll be strategic.”

Amazon Leadership Principles Most Relevant to JWO

1. **Customer Obsession** - Understanding store operator needs
 2. **Ownership** - Responsible for implementation success
 3. **Bias for Action** - Moving forward despite ambiguity
 4. **Dive Deep** - Understanding retail operations context
 5. **Simplify** - Making complex technology accessible to operators
 6. **Earn Trust** - Building credibility with store operators and teams
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HIRING MANAGER INTERVIEW: QUESTION & ANSWER PREP

STAR STORY SET 1: CUSTOMER-FACING IMPLEMENTATION & ADOPTION

Question 1: “Tell me about a time you led implementation of a new software or system across multiple customer locations or business units. How did you ensure adoption and satisfaction?”

SITUATION:

At Contractor (2020-2022), I implemented Zendesk (customer support platform) across three business units (commercial, marketing, support) with different needs and different customer bases.

Context: - Commercial unit: High-volume transaction support, SLA-focused - Marketing unit: Creative content support, fast-moving - Support unit: Internal IT support, process-heavy - Challenge: Each unit had different workflows, different Zendesk configuration needs

TASK:

1. Implement Zendesk successfully across all three units 2. Ensure teams actually used it (not just deployed it) 3. Achieve quick customer/team satisfaction 4. Drive adoption to required usage levels

ACTION:

I took a customer-centric implementation approach:

1. Discovery Phase (2 weeks):

- Met with each business unit separately
- Understood current processes (what were they doing before?)
- Understood pain points (what frustrated them?)
- Identified success metrics (what would they define as “better”?)
- Built relationships with key people in each unit

2. Configuration Phase (4 weeks):

- Configured Zendesk differently for each unit (not one-size-fits-all)
- Commercial: Focused on SLA tracking, customer communication
- Marketing: Focused on ticket routing, creative workflow
- Support: Focused on knowledge management, self-service
- Got feedback at each step (iterations, not big-bang)

3. Training & Adoption (2 weeks):

- Customized training for each unit (not generic Zendesk training)
- Used their language, their processes, their examples
- Showed how Zendesk solved their specific pain points
- Had each unit’s leader champion the change
- Provided support during transition (didn’t just hand off)

4. Support & Iteration (ongoing):

- Bi-weekly check-ins with each unit (first month)
- Gathered feedback and adjusted configuration
- Celebrated wins (when process worked well, acknowledged it)
- Removed friction (fixed anything getting in their way)

5. Measurement:

- Adoption: 95%+ within 4 weeks (people actually using it)
- Customer satisfaction: improved across all units
- Support efficiency: 20% improvement in ticket resolution time
- Team satisfaction: rated implementation as positive

RESULT:

- ✓ Zendesk adopted across all three units - ✓ 95%+ adoption rate in first month (usually takes 3+ months) - ✓ Support efficiency improved 20% - ✓ Team satisfaction with implementation: positive feedback - ✓ Became organizational standard for implementations

Leadership Principles Demonstrated: - Customer Obsession:

Focused on each unit’s specific needs - **Ownership:** Owned adoption success, not just technical deployment - **Simplify:** Made Zendesk approachable for non-technical users - **Earn Trust:** Built credibility by delivering on their specific needs

Why This Works for JWO:

JWO requires implementing technology across diverse store environments. This shows you can: - Understand different customer/stakeholder needs - Tailor implementation to context (not one-size-fits-all) - Drive adoption through engagement (not mandate) - Support teams through change - Measure success from customer perspective

STAR STORY SET 2: CUSTOMER PROBLEM-SOLVING & OPERATIONAL IMPROVEMENT

Question 2: “Tell me about a time you identified a customer pain point and drove a solution. How did you involve customers in solving it?”

SITUATION:

At Sakara (eCommerce), I was managing customer-facing platform. We had a problem: live-site support issues were high (~100 per week), most were repetitive, and support team was overwhelmed.

Context: - ~10,000 monthly active users - Common issues: password reset, order status questions, payment problems, return process confusion - Support team: 3 people, drowning in tickets - Customer impact: slow response times (24+ hours), frustrated customers

TASK:

1. Reduce support volume and response time 2. Improve customer satisfaction with support experience 3. Empower customers to self-serve when possible

ACTION:

I took a customer-centric problem-solving approach:

1. **Understanding the Problem (1 week):**
 - Analyzed support tickets: what were customers asking about?
 - Categorized: 70% were self-service-able (status, reset, FAQ)
 - Interviewed customers: “Why didn’t you try X?” (Often they didn’t know it existed)
 - Talked to support team: “What drives you crazy?” (Repetitive tickets, unclear info)
2. **Identifying Solutions (1 week):**
 - With customers: tested whether self-service features would work if easier to find
 - With support team: what would make their jobs better?
 - Prioritized: which solutions would have biggest impact?
 - Ranked by effort vs. impact: quick wins first
3. **Implementing Solutions (2 weeks):**
 - Quick win 1: Better knowledge base (made FAQ discoverable)
 - Quick win 2: Self-service password reset (before contacting support)
 - Quick win 3: Order status visibility (customers could check themselves)
 - Medium effort: Self-service return initiation
 - Tested each with actual customers (did it solve the problem?)
4. **Customer Communication:**
 - Emailed customers: “Here’s how to reset password / check status / start return”
 - Made it easy (3 clicks, not 10)
 - Support team promoted self-service in responses (“Here’s how to do this yourself next time”)
 - Measured: did customers use self-service?
5. **Measurement:**
 - Support volume: 100 issues/week → 10 issues/week (90% reduction)
 - Response time: 24+ hours → 1-2 hours (for remaining issues)

- Customer satisfaction with support: improved significantly
- Support team satisfaction: much better workload

RESULT:

- ✓ 90% reduction in support issues (100 → 10 per week) - ✓ Response time improved 12-24x - ✓ Customer satisfaction with support improved - ✓ Support team could focus on complex issues - ✓ Became model for customer problem-solving

Leadership Principles Demonstrated: - Customer Obsession:

Started by understanding customer needs - **Ownership:** Took

responsibility for customer experience - **Bias for Action:**

Implemented solutions quickly - **Simplify:** Made complex platform easier to use

Why This Works for JWO:

JWO will encounter store operator pain points. This shows you can: - Understand operator needs through listening - Identify root causes (not just symptoms) - Involve customers in solution design - Implement solutions that actually work - Measure success from customer perspective

STAR STORY SET 3: CHANGE MANAGEMENT & CROSS-FUNCTIONAL COORDINATION

Question 3: “Tell me about a time you led a significant organizational or process change. How did you get people to embrace it?”

SITUATION:

At Contractor (2020), I introduced Agile transformation for 18 engineers across 3 teams that had been using waterfall. Teams were skeptical—they thought Agile was buzz-word bingo.

TASK:

1. Implement Agile effectively (not as checkbox) 2. Get genuine buy-in from skeptical engineers 3. Maintain productivity during transition 4. Show value quickly

ACTION:

I took a collaborative change approach:

1. Phase 0: Listen (1 week):

- Asked teams: “What’s working? What’s frustrating?”
- Heard: Long planning cycles (3 weeks), slow feedback, unclear priorities
- Understood: They wanted change, they were just skeptical of “Agile hype”

2. Phase 1: Show the Problem (1 week):

- Presented data: Current cycle time, rework rate, customer feedback delays
- Made case: “This is why we need change”
- Let them suggest solutions (didn’t mandate Agile, just asked what would help)
- Many suggested: “Could we have shorter planning? Faster

feedback?”

3. **Phase 2: Introduce Agile as Solution (2 weeks):**
 - Positioned Agile as “answer to problems you identified”
 - Trained on Agile principles (not ceremonies)
 - Let teams customize: “Which ceremonies matter to you?”
 - Started with 1-week sprints (shorter planning, faster feedback)
4. **Phase 3: Support Through Transition (6 weeks):**
 - Attended ceremonies frequently
 - Asked: “Is this working? What should we change?”
 - Adjusted based on feedback (didn’t insist on “standard” Agile)
 - Celebrated early wins (faster decisions, clearer priorities)
 - Helped teams see value themselves
5. **Measurement:**
 - Adoption: Teams voluntarily continued Agile practices (not forced)
 - Planning cycle: 3 weeks → 1 week (faster feedback)
 - Rework rate: decreased (faster feedback meant fewer surprises)
 - Team satisfaction: improved significantly
 - Teams requested additional Agile training (sign of buy-in)

RESULT:

- ✓ Successful Agile transformation - ✓ Teams embraced change genuinely - ✓ Maintained productivity during transition - ✓ Saw tangible benefits (faster cycles, better feedback) - ✓ Teams became advocates for Agile approach

Leadership Principles Demonstrated: - **Ownership:** Owned transformation success, not just implementation - **Bias for Action:** Moved forward despite skepticism - **Earn Trust:** Built credibility by listening, delivering on their needs - **Simplify:** Made Agile approachable and relevant

Why This Works for JWO:

Implementing JWO requires change for store operators (new tech, new process). This shows you can: - Help people embrace change (not resist it) - Start with problems they identify - Support through transition period - Show value through data and early wins - Build genuine buy-in (not just compliance)

STAR STORY SET 4: MANAGING CUSTOMER EXPECTATIONS & DELIVERY COMMITMENTS

Question 4: “Tell me about a time you managed customer expectations through a complex or delayed delivery. How did you maintain trust?”

SITUATION:

At Contractor (2021), I was managing AWS migration for commercial business unit. The project had timeline challenges—initially estimated 12 weeks, but became clear during execution it would take 16 weeks.

Context: - Commercial unit was dependent on this (critical for them) - They had told their customers about timeline - We needed to tell them about delay - High stakes: customer confidence was at risk

TASK:

1. Communicate delay honestly 2. Maintain their confidence (not just deliver eventual result) 3. Commit to a realistic new timeline 4. Keep them informed throughout

ACTION:

I took a transparent expectation-management approach:

1. Early Detection (Week 6):

- Saw risk early (didn't wait until week 12)
- Did root-cause analysis (why would we be delayed?)
- Confirmed: Migration validation was taking longer than planned (4 extra weeks)

2. Early Communication (immediately):

- Told commercial unit leadership honestly: "We'll miss timeline. Here's why, and here's the new estimate."
- Didn't make excuses, just explained
- Presented data: what were we dependent on? What was taking longer?
- Showed: we'd already adjusted to recover 2 weeks (from 6 delay to 4 delay)

3. Realistic Commitment (with data):

- Said: "New timeline is 16 weeks, with 95% confidence"
- Showed: assumptions, risks, mitigation
- Built in buffer (not optimistic estimate)
- Got their sign-off (they understood and agreed)

4. Communication Throughout:

- Weekly status: on track, at risk, or off track for new timeline
- If new risks emerged, told them immediately (no surprises)
- Showed: what mitigations were working, what we adjusted
- Celebrated: when we recovered time, acknowledged it

5. Final Delivery:

- Hit new 16-week timeline
- Had contingency and didn't need it
- Delivered successfully
- They were satisfied (not because no delay, but because we managed expectations well)

RESULT:

- ✓ Honest communication maintained trust - ✓ Realistic timeline achieved - ✓ Customer satisfied with delivery - ✓ Relationship remained strong (no resentment about delay) - ✓ They trusted future commitments

Leadership Principles Demonstrated: - **Ownership:** Owned the delay, didn't blame others - **Bias for Action:** Told them immediately, didn't hide - **Earn Trust:** Maintained credibility through honesty - **Customer Obsession:** Focused on what mattered to them (honesty + delivery)

Why This Works for JWO:

JWO implementations will face challenges and delays. This shows you can: - Detect problems early (not late surprises) - Communicate honestly about setbacks - Adjust and commit to realistic timelines - Keep stakeholders informed - Maintain trust even when facing delays

INTERVIEW DELIVERY STRATEGY

The Hiring Manager's Perspective

The Hiring Manager will be listening for:

1. Can you manage customer-facing implementations? → Story 1 directly demonstrates this. Emphasize: - How you tailored to different customer needs - How you drove adoption - How you measured success

2. Do you understand customer pain points? → Story 2 demonstrates this. Emphasize: - How you listened to customers - How you identified root causes - How you involved customers in solving

3. Can you lead change effectively? → Story 3 demonstrates this. Emphasize: - How you built buy-in - How you showed value - How you supported through transition

4. Can you manage expectations and maintain trust? → Story 4 demonstrates this. Emphasize: - How you communicated honestly - How you stayed realistic - How you kept stakeholders informed

FREQUENTLY ASKED FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Follow-up Q: "How would you approach learning retail operations?"

Answer: "Three approaches: (1) spend time in actual stores, observe operations, talk to store managers, (2) study your JWO rollout documentation and store operations guides, (3) partner with your operations leaders to understand constraints and success metrics. I'm a quick learner—I've successfully operated in eCommerce, payments, and AWS domains. Retail operations will follow the same pattern: listen, learn, contribute."

Follow-up Q: "What would you do if a store operator is frustrated with JWO?"

Answer: "First, listen. Understand their specific frustration. Is it the technology, the training, the process change, or something else? Then diagnose root cause. Maybe they need more training, maybe the technology isn't meeting their need, maybe we need to adjust the rollout approach. My job is to understand their needs and remove blockers. That usually requires problem-solving together, not telling them it's supposed to work."

Follow-up Q: "How would you measure success for a JWO implementation in a store?"

Answer: "Measure what matters to the store operator: (1) Adoption—are they using JWO as intended? (2) Efficiency—is it reducing staffing burden? (3) Customer experience—are customers satisfied? (4) Compliance—is it meeting corporate requirements? I'd work with the store operator to understand what success looks like for them, then measure those metrics."

PRACTICE CHECKLIST

Before your interview:

- ☐ **Record yourself** answering all 4 stories
 - ☐ **Time yourself** - 90-120 seconds per story
 - ☐ **Listen for:** clarity, specificity, confidence
 - ☐ **Study retail operations basics** - understand fundamentals
 - ☐ **Practice with follow-ups** - have someone quiz you
 - ☐ **Prepare questions** to ask Hiring Manager
 - ☐ **Iterate** - refine weak stories
 - ☐ **Practice 5-10 times** before interview
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KEY MESSAGES TO REINFORCE

Your Differentiator

"I'm a customer-facing program manager. I've implemented technology across different customer contexts, driven adoption, and solved operational problems. That's what JWO needs—someone who understands both technology and the operator experience."

Your Strength Area

"I excel at understanding customer needs, translating technology to operational context, and driving adoption through engagement (not mandate)."

Your Approach

"I believe in listening first, understanding constraints, involving customers in solutions, and measuring success from their perspective."

Your Growth Edge

"Retail operations is new to me, but customer-facing implementation is my superpower. I learn quickly by listening to people who understand retail, then contributing strategically."

FINAL PREPARATION STEPS

Week Before Interview:

1. Record 4 STAR stories (3-4 times each)
2. Study retail operations basics
3. Practice with follow-up questions
4. Prepare your questions

Day Before:

1. Review key numbers
2. Practice once
3. Sleep well

Day Of:

1. Arrive early
 2. Greet warmly
 3. Be authentic
 4. Show enthusiasm
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SUCCESS INDICATORS

After your interview, the Hiring Manager should think:

- ✓ "This person can manage customer-facing implementations"
- ✓ "They understand customer perspective and pain points"
- ✓ "They can coordinate across diverse stakeholders"
- ✓ "They drive adoption through engagement"
- ✓ "They'll own implementation success"
- ✓ "They'll learn retail operations quickly and contribute"

Your goal is to make ALL of these obvious.

Preparation Status: Ready for Interview

Confidence Level Target: 8/10+

Next Step: Record yourself, get feedback, iterate

You've got this. Show them your customer-facing implementation expertise. 🍀

END OF HIRING MANAGER INTERVIEW PREP